



Amazon Alexa (Source: www.businessinsider.in)

wanted Alexa to know everything—exactly like The Library of Alexandria, the keeper of all knowledge. Another reason was the unique sound the combination of soft vowels and the alphabet X brought about.

Benefits. Alexa must be the first product you get when you start creating your Smart Home. Getting and Echo from the available range will be the best bet. Ease and flexibility of the Echo ecosystem are amazing. The products can be plugged in anywhere

and are easy to set up. Echo Dot is one of the cheapest home controller speakers in the market today. Alexa has more than 10,000 skills and is evolving further at a fast pace. It is highly compatible with both Android and Apple devices.

Challenges. Configuring Alexa app for a few third-party products, both for Android and iPhone smartphones, can be quite challenging. Alexa may not be able to respond to a few of your queries within the expected time frame. At times, it is slow to respond. The Echo speaker quality is average.

Alexa can't function from your phone, you need a speaker. Amazon doesn't take data responsibility for third-party devices configured with Alexa; companies have access to your data and may use it as required.

Google's Assistant

You may ask your Google Assistant questions on any topic. It is like Google help, always there whenever you need some information.

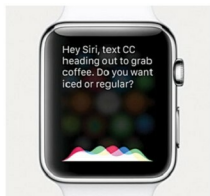
Benefits. Its greatest benefit is

the power of Google search. Google's assistant can probably provide answers to almost all of your queries as it has access to massive and supreme data of Google search. Google's smartphones and speakers work on the latest Android versions. The associated hardware is moderately priced.

Challenges. Third-party products, especially for home automation, are mostly Alexa compatible. Saying Ok Google to activate the assistant may become boring for users. Audio quality of Google products is not very good. Also, Google collects your data.

Apple's Siri

I have been using Siri for the last couple of years. I am impressed with its increasing abilities. It takes care

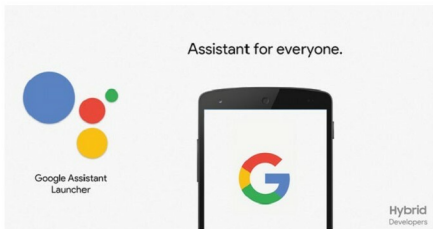


Siri (Source: www.idownloadblog.com)

of my calendar, books a cab for me, plays music based on my preferences and helps me find relevant answers through a quick web search.

Benefits. Apple takes privacy very seriously. Even the third-party devices use encryption for data transfer and management. Siri can be integrated with Apple's Home Kit to increase its functionality. It is quite easy to work with.

Challenges. Because of the higher security and privacy checks by Apple, there are not many devices that support Siri. Also, most of the Apple products are quite costly. **BEV**



Google Assistant (Source: <https://labs.xda-developers.com>)